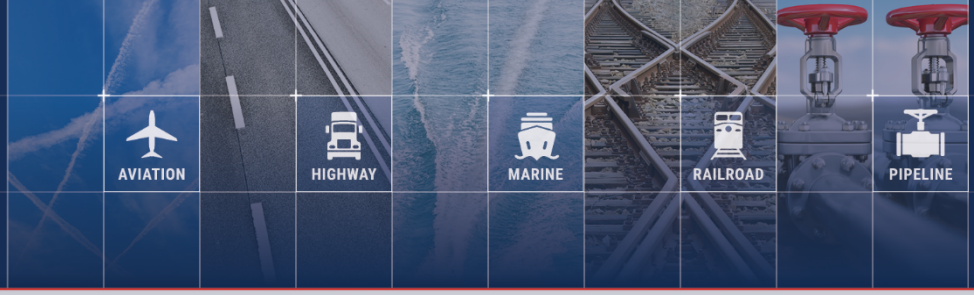

Aviation Investigation Final Report

Location:	Waimea, Hawaii	**Accident Number:**	ANC25LA013
Date & Time:	December 23, 2024, 11:00 Local	**Registration:**	N7143E
Aircraft:	Cessna 182B	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:	Fuel starvation	**Injuries:**	2 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General aviation - Personal		

Analysis

The pilot, who was a flight instructor, seated in the left seat, stated that while approaching their destination airport during the non-instructional flight, the engine “sputtered” and lost all power due to fuel starvation. The pilot made a forced landing into an open field short of the runway. During the forced landing roll, the airplane impacted a herd of sheep and sustained substantial damage to the fuselage.

Postaccident examination revealed no abnormalities with the airplane’s fuel system or engine that would have prevented normal operation. However, the wings had been removed and any fuel onboard was discarded before the postaccident examination of the wreckage. The pilot reported they departed with 70 gallons of fuel in the airplane.

The student pilot-rated passenger, seated in the right seat, reported the pilot stated they had three hours of fuel onboard for the two-hour flight. Both pilots reported that the fuel selector was in the BOTH position and that, after the accident, the left fuel tank was empty and the right fuel tank still contained fuel.

The pilot stated that the engine lost total power due to fuel starvation. The pilot likely did not monitor the fuel quantity during the flight. Had the fuel quantity gauges been monitored, the pilot would have recognized the imbalance.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be:

The pilot’s inadequate monitoring of the fuel status while en route, which resulted in a total loss of engine power due to fuel starvation.

Findings

Personnel issues	Use of equip/system - Pilot
Aircraft	Fuel - Fluid level
Aircraft	Fuel - Fluid management
Environmental issues	Rough terrain - Contributed to outcome
Environmental issues	Animal(s)/bird(s) - Contributed to outcome
Personnel issues	Task scheduling - Pilot
Personnel issues	Monitoring equip/instruments - Pilot
Personnel issues	Task monitoring/vigilance - Pilot
Personnel issues	Identification/recognition - Pilot

Factual Information

History of Flight

Enroute	Fuel starvation (Defining event)

On December 23, 2024, about 1100 Hawaii-Aleutian standard time, a Cessna 182B airplane, N7143E, sustained substantial damage when it was involved in an accident near Waimea, Hawaii. The pilot and student pilot-rated passenger were not injured. The airplane was operated as a Title 14 *Code of Federal Regulations* Part 91 non-instructional personal flight.

The pilot, seated in the left seat, who was also a flight instructor, reported that while en route to the destination airport, the engine “sputtered” and then lost all power due to fuel starvation. The pilot then selected an open field short of the runway as a forced landing site. After landing, during the landing roll, the airplane impacted a herd of sheep, and the nose wheel collapsed, resulting in substantial damage to the fuselage.

The student pilot-rated passenger, seated in the right seat, reported that they were about two hours into the flight, and had almost reached their destination, circling over the city in a left-hand turn. The engine then “hiccupped” and they made a forced landing into a field short of the runway. The student pilot-rated passenger reported that there were no unusual smells or sounds before the engine problem. During the landing roll out, about 50 yards, he said the nose wheel collapsed.

After landing they examined the fuel tanks with the airplane in a nose-low attitude and found sufficient fuel in the right-wing fuel tank but could not see any fuel in the left-wing fuel tank. The student pilot-rated passenger reported that he did not remember the pilot conducting a predeparture fuel check or checking the fuel tank indicators in the cockpit during the flight. Before takeoff, the student pilot-rated passenger asked how much fuel the pilot put into the airplane for the flight; she told him that she added three hours of fuel and that the flight would be only two hours long. The student pilot-rated passenger felt comfortable with that answer and fuel was never discussed again until after the accident. After the accident, the fuel selector was found in the “both” position and the student pilot-rated passenger does not remember seeing it moved in flight.

The pilot reported they departed with 70 gallons of fuel in the airplane.

A postaccident examination by a Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) airworthiness inspector from the Honolulu Flight Standards District Office (FSDO) revealed the wings had been removed and any fuel discarded before his arrival. Engine control continuity was established from the cockpit to the engine. The fuel selector was tested and operated

normally, and fuel vents were clear of obstructions. Fuel was found in the fuel line from the gascolator to the carburetor and in the carburetor bowl. The engine's crankshaft turned freely by hand with no abnormal noises heard. Thumb compression was observed in all cylinders. A click from the magneto impulse coupler could be heard at the top of dead center of each cylinder during rotation. Visual inspection of the engine's exterior showed no abnormalities. No anomalies were identified with the airframe or engine that would have prevented normal operation.

Pilot Information

Certificate:	Commercial; Flight instructor	**Age:**	48,Female
Airplane Rating(s):	Single-engine land; Multi-engine land	**Seat Occupied:**	Left
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	Glider	**Restraint Used:**	Lap only
Instrument Rating(s):	Airplane	**Second Pilot Present:**	Yes
Instructor Rating(s):	Airplane single-engine; Glider; Instrument airplane; Sport pilot	**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:	Class 3 With waivers/limitations	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	November 1, 2024
Occupational Pilot:	Yes	**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	May 1, 2023
Flight Time:	10000 hours (Total, all aircraft), 3000 hours (Total, this make and model), 9900 hours (Pilot In Command, all aircraft), 300 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 90 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft), 2 hours (Last 24 hours, all aircraft)		

Student pilot Information

Certificate:		**Age:**	32,Male
Airplane Rating(s):	None	**Seat Occupied:**	Right
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	Lap only
Instrument Rating(s):	None	**Second Pilot Present:**	Yes
Instructor Rating(s):	None	**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:	None	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	
Occupational Pilot:	No	**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:	10 hours (Total, all aircraft), 2 hours (Total, this make and model)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Cessna	**Registration:**	N7143E
Model/Series:	182B	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:	1959	**Amateur Built:**	
Airworthiness Certificate:	Normal	**Serial Number:**	52143
Landing Gear Type:	Tricycle	**Seats:**	2
Date/Type of Last Inspection:	October 14, 2024 Annual	**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	
Time Since Last Inspection:	73 Hrs	**Engines:**	1
Airframe Total Time:	6178.8 Hrs as of last inspection	**Engine Manufacturer:**	
ELT:	C91A installed, activated, aided in locating accident	**Engine Model/Series:**	
Registered Owner:	PFISTERS FLYING WAHINE LLC	**Rated Power:**	
Operator:	On file	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual (VMC)	**Condition of Light:**	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:	PHSF,5900 ft msl	**Distance from Accident Site:**	15 Nautical Miles
Observation Time:	10:55 Local	**Direction from Accident Site:**	153°
Lowest Cloud Condition:	Clear	**Visibility**	10 miles
Lowest Ceiling:	None	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	20 knots / 25 knots	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	None / Terrain-Induced
Wind Direction:	120°	**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	N/A / Light
Altimeter Setting:	30.45 inches Hg	**Temperature/Dew Point:**	20°C / 7°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	Mokileia, HI (HDH)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:	Waimea-Kohala , HI (HMU)	**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:	09:00 Local	**Type of Airspace:**	Class E

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:		**Aircraft Explosion:**	None
Total Injuries:	2 None	**Latitude, Longitude:**	19.988556,-155.67623(est)

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Ward, Mark
Additional Participating Persons:	Andrew Rasmussen; FAA; Honolulu , HI
Original Publish Date:	September 30, 2025
Last Revision Date:	
Investigation Class:	Class 3
Note:	The NTSB did not travel to the scene of this accident.
Investigation Docket:	https://data.ntsb.gov/Docket?ProjectID=199472

The National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB) is an independent federal agency charged by Congress with investigating every civil aviation accident in the United States and significant events in other modes of transportation—railroad, transit, highway, marine, pipeline, and commercial space. We determine the probable causes of the accidents and events we investigate, and issue safety recommendations aimed at preventing future occurrences. In addition, we conduct transportation safety research studies and offer information and other assistance to family members and survivors for each accident or event we investigate. We also serve as the appellate authority for enforcement actions involving aviation and mariner certificates issued by the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) and US Coast Guard, and we adjudicate appeals of civil penalty actions taken by the FAA.

The NTSB does not assign fault or blame for an accident or incident; rather, as specified by NTSB regulation, "accident/incident investigations are fact-finding proceedings with no formal issues and no adverse parties … and are not conducted for the purpose of determining the rights or liabilities of any person" (Title 49 *Code of Federal Regulations* section 831.4). Assignment of fault or legal liability is not relevant to the NTSB's statutory mission to improve transportation safety by investigating accidents and incidents and issuing safety recommendations. In addition, statutory language prohibits the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report (Title 49 *United States Code* section 1154(b)). A factual report that may be admissible under 49 *United States Code* section 1154(b) is available here.